Until we are all equal

Participatory Climate Risk and Vulnerability Assessment for Gender Responsive Climate Adaptation and Preparedness Plans (GRAPP) in Kilifi County.

Final Kilifi County Community Risk Preparedness Plan 2025-2030

Consultant

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List of Acronyms

ASAL	Arid and Semi-Arid Lands
CBO	Community-Based Organization
CCCF	County Climate Change Fund
CDCC	County Disaster Command Centre
CDMU	County Disaster Management Unit
CEWARN	Conflict Early Warning and Response Mechanism
CIDP	County Integrated Development Plan
CSG	County Steering Group
CSO	Civil Society Organization
DCC	Deputy County Commissioner
DRR	Disaster Risk Reduction
EDE	Ending Drought Emergencies
EWS	Early Warning System
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization
GBV	Gender Based ViolenceIGAD Intergovernmental Authority on Development
KCCAP	Kenya Climate Change Action Plan
KFS	Kenya Forest Service
KLH	Knowledge and Learning Hub
KMD	Kenya Meteorological Department
KMFRI	Kenya Marine and Fisheries Research Institute
KRCS	Kenya Red Cross Society
KSH	Kenya Shilling
KYEOP	Kenya Youth Employment and Opportunities Project
MSCP	Multi-Stakeholder Coordination Platform
NDMA	National Drought Management Authority
NDC	Nationally Determined Contribution
NDOC	National Disaster Operations Centre
NEMA	National Environment Management Authority
NFIs	Non-Food Items
NGO	Non-Governmental Organization
NRM	Natural Resource Management
PDAR	Post-Disaster Assessment Report
PFMA	Public Finance Management Act
PIFS	Public Information and Feedback System
PCVA	Participatory Climate Vulnerability and Capacity Assessment
PADs	Persons Abled Differently
PPP	Public–Private Partnership
RMPU	Resource Mobilization and Partnerships Unit
SACCO	Savings and Credit Cooperative Organization
SDGs	Sustainable Development Goals
SRHR	Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights
SSP	Shared Socioeconomic Pathway
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
VSLA	Village Savings and Loan Association
VDRT	Village Disaster Response Team
WCCPC	Ward Climate Change Planning Committee
WCF	Ward Climate Fund
WEF	Women Enterprise Fund
WRUA	Water Resource Users Association
WWF	World Wide Fund for Nature

1 Introduction

1.1 Purpose

The Kilifi County Community Risk Preparedness Plan (2025–2030) establishes a strategic framework to enhance the county's ability to anticipate, prepare for, respond to, and recover from climate-induced hazards. Its overarching goal is to safeguard human lives, livelihoods, and public assets, while protecting vital ecosystems and promoting climate-resilient development pathways aligned with the county's long-term sustainability vision.

Kilifi County continues to experience heightened exposure to multiple and interlinked hazards, including recurrent droughts, floods, strong winds, human–wildlife conflicts, pest and disease outbreaks, and coral bleaching, whose intensity and frequency have increased due to climate variability and environmental degradation. These hazards have far-reaching implications, resulting in water scarcity, crop failure, loss of biodiversity, infrastructure damage, and public health risks that undermine the socio-economic stability of both rural and peri-urban communities.

The plan seeks to address these vulnerabilities through proactive preparedness measures that strengthen institutional coordination, enhance community awareness, and improve emergency response and recovery mechanisms. It emphasizes readiness at both the county and ward levels, ensuring the continuity of essential services such as water supply, healthcare, and education during crises, and fostering rapid, inclusive, and sustainable recovery processes thereafter.

This preparedness framework operationalizes national and county commitments to climate resilience and disaster management, notably the Kenya Climate Change Act (2023), the National Adaptation Plan (2015–2030), and the Kilifi County Climate Change Action Plan (2023–2027). It further aligns with the County Integrated Development Plan (CIDP 2023–2027) and the County Disaster Risk Management Framework, translating strategic policy objectives into localized, actionable interventions for Sokoke, Mnarani, and Mwarakaya Wards.

Recognizing that disaster impacts are inherently gender-differentiated, the plan adopts a gender-responsive and socially inclusive approach that ensures equitable participation and benefit-sharing among women, youth, and persons abled differently (PADs). Women in Kilifi, who are predominantly responsible for water collection, household management, and caregiving, face elevated risks during drought and flood events. Similarly, youth and PADs remain disproportionately vulnerable due to high unemployment rates, mobility constraints, and limited resource access. By integrating gender equality and social inclusion into all stages of preparedness planning, the plan seeks to empower all social groups as active agents in disaster anticipation, response, and recovery.

Anchored on multi-sectoral collaboration, evidence-based decision-making, and community participation, this document provides a roadmap for building a climate-resilient Kilifi County. It draws upon findings from Participatory Climate Vulnerability and Capacity Assessments (PCVAs) conducted in Mnarani, Mwarakaya, and Sokoke Wards, which revealed distinct exposure patterns across the county's varied landscapes, from the forest-adjacent ecosystems of Sokoke, to the coastal and marine zones of Mnarani, and the inland agricultural systems of Mwarakaya. Each of these zones demands context-specific preparedness interventions tailored to their unique environmental and socio-economic contexts.

1.2 Scope

The scope of the Kilifi County Community Risk Preparedness Plan extends to all seven sub-counties; Kilifi North, Kilifi South, Ganze, Kaloleni, Rabai, Magarini, and Malindi with focused

implementation in Sokoke, Mnarani, and Mwarakaya Wards. These wards represent diverse ecological and socio-economic settings that reflect the county's broader risk landscape.

The plan covers a five-year implementation period (2025–2030) and encompasses both rapid-onset hazards (e.g., floods, human-wildlife strong winds, and disease outbreaks) and slow-onset hazards (e.g., drought, coastal erosion, and land degradation). It applies to all key development sectors, including water and sanitation, agriculture, fisheries, health, infrastructure, forestry, education, and environment.

This preparedness framework targets both institutional systems such as county departments, disaster units, humanitarian organizations, and private sector actors and community-level structures, including Ward Climate Change Planning Committees (WCCPCs), Village Disaster Response Teams (VDRTs), Beach Management Units (BMUs), Water Resource Users Associations (WRUAs), and local youth and women's groups. This dual approach ensures both vertical coordination (between county and ward levels) and horizontal integration (across thematic sectors and stakeholders).

Geographically, Kilifi County spans approximately 12,245 km², characterized by a mix of coastal lowlands, rolling hills, river valleys, and forested zones. It borders the Indian Ocean to the east and is traversed by major rivers such as Sabaki (Galana) and Rare, which serve as lifelines for water supply and agriculture but also pose periodic flooding risks. Coastal areas like Mnarani face threats of sea-level rise and saline intrusion, while inland areas such as Mwarakaya and Sokoke grapple with droughts, forest degradation, and soil erosion.

The plan further prioritizes ecosystem integrity as a core element of disaster preparedness. The Arabuko-Sokoke Forest, a globally recognized biodiversity hotspot, is under increasing stress from encroachment and unsustainable resource use. Degradation of such ecosystems undermines natural buffers against hazards like floods, heat stress, and windstorms. Consequently, this plan emphasizes ecosystem-based adaptation measures to complement infrastructure and policy interventions.

Lastly, the plan underscores the importance of community-driven preparedness empowering local actors to take the lead in hazard monitoring, early warning dissemination, and emergency response. It establishes mechanisms for prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response, and recovery, ensuring resilience across all governance levels and social groups.

2 Climate Risk Assessment

2.1 Hazard identification

Kilifi County remains highly susceptible to multiple climate-induced and environmental hazards owing to its diverse topography, proximity to the Indian Ocean, and heavy dependence on natural resource-based livelihoods. Findings from the Participatory Climate Vulnerability and Capacity Assessments (PCVAs, 2025) conducted in Sokoke, Mnarani, and Mwarakaya Wards reveal a complex hazard landscape characterized by recurrent droughts, floods, pest and disease outbreaks, strong winds, human–wildlife conflicts, environmental degradation, and coral bleaching, particularly affecting coastal villages such as Timboni (Table 1).

Drought is the most widespread and persistent hazard across the county, with prolonged spells increasing the frequency and duration. These events have severely disrupted rain-fed agricultural systems and diminished water availability for both human and livestock use. In Mwarakaya Ward, smallholder farmers who rely on subsistence agriculture experience significant crop losses during extended droughts, leading to food insecurity and income decline. In Sokoke Ward, drought-induced water scarcity has escalated competition for limited water resources between humans and wildlife, exerting additional stress on the Arabuko-Sokoke Forest ecosystem. Meanwhile, in Mnarani Ward, declining rainfall and saline intrusion into groundwater sources exacerbate domestic water shortages and reduce water quality, particularly in villages such as Takaungu and Vuma.

Flooding poses recurrent risks, especially during the long rains (March–May) and short rains (October–December). Low-lying coastal areas in Mnarani and parts of Mwarakaya are frequently inundated by flash floods that destroy roads, bridges, homes, and farmlands. Floodwaters often carry debris and contaminants, leading to waterborne diseases and the destruction of agricultural assets. In Sokoke Ward, heavy downpours intensify soil erosion on hilly terrain, causing siltation of rivers, degradation of farmlands, and reduced soil productivity.

Pest and disease outbreaks have intensified in recent years, driven by fluctuating temperatures and erratic rainfall patterns. Farmers across all three wards report infestations of fall armyworms, locusts, and aphids that devastate key food crops such as maize, cassava, and vegetables. Livestock are equally affected by endemic diseases like East Coast fever and Newcastle disease, which reduce herd productivity and household income. Human health risks are also amplified by vector-borne diseases such as malaria and dengue fever, which spike after flood events due to stagnant water and poor sanitation infrastructure.

Environmental degradation remains an overarching driver of vulnerability in Kilifi County. Unregulated sand harvesting, deforestation, charcoal burning, and unsustainable agricultural practices have contributed to soil erosion, reduced fertility, and habitat loss. In Sokoke, encroachment into the Arabuko-Sokoke Forest for timber and fuelwood has disrupted wildlife habitats and impaired the forest's ecological functions, including rainfall regulation and groundwater recharge. Mnarani continues to experience severe coastal erosion due to sand mining and poorly planned infrastructure development, while in Mwarakaya, land degradation from over-cultivation and poor soil management has intensified drought impacts and reduced crop yields.

Human–wildlife conflicts are particularly prevalent in Sokoke and adjacent villages bordering the forest ecosystem. Elephants, baboons, and monkeys frequently raid farms, destroying crops and threatening community safety. These conflicts, which occur approximately once every eight years, are exacerbated by shrinking wildlife habitats, prolonged dry spells, and inadequate compensation or deterrent mechanisms. Limited collaboration between communities and

wildlife authorities has further heightened tensions, undermining coexistence and conservation efforts.

Strong winds are also recurrent hazards during the monsoon transition periods (April–May and October–November). Along the coastal belt of Mnarani, strong winds disrupt fishing activities, damage boats and houses, and uproot trees. Inland, in Sokoke and Mwarakaya, windstorms occasionally damage farm structures and community facilities, causing localized economic losses and safety risks.

Coral bleaching has emerged as a critical hazard in coastal ecosystems, particularly in Timboni Village within Mnarani Ward. Rising sea surface temperatures, coupled with pollution and sedimentation, have caused widespread bleaching and mortality of coral reefs. This has disrupted marine biodiversity, reduced fish stocks, and negatively affected the livelihoods of coastal households that depend on artisanal fishing and tourism. The degradation of coral ecosystems also diminishes natural coastal protection, increasing the vulnerability of shoreline communities to storm surges and erosion.

Table 1: Key Climate Hazards in Kilifi County (Source: Kilifi County Hazard Atlas and PCVA 2025)

Hazard	Frequency	Most Affected Areas	Key Impacts
Drought	High (annual to biannual)	Sokoke, Mwarakaya	Crop failure, water scarcity, livestock mortality, food insecurity
Floods	Moderate to high	Mnarani, Mwarakaya	Infrastructure damage, displacement, disease outbreaks, erosion
Pest and diseases	Moderate	County-wide,	Crop and livestock losses, human health risks, increased production costs
Environmental degradation	High	Sokoke, Mnarani, Mwarakaya	Deforestation, soil erosion, reduced biodiversity, coastal erosion
Human-wildlife conflicts	Moderate	Sokoke and forest-edge villages	Crop destruction, injuries, loss of income, fear and insecurity
Strong winds	Seasonal	Mwarakaya and Sokoke	Damage to property, marine accidents, disrupted power and communication lines
Coral bleaching	High	Timboni	Loss of marine biodiversity, decline in fish stocks, reduced coastal protection, and diminished tourism potential

2.2 Vulnerability analysis

Vulnerability to climate hazards in Kilifi County is shaped by a combination of environmental fragility, socio-economic conditions, and institutional limitations. The PCVAs undertaken in the three wards highlighted how heavy reliance on natural resources such as agriculture, forestry, and fisheries makes households particularly sensitive to climatic shocks (Table 2).

In Mwarakaya, subsistence farming is the backbone of livelihoods, yet productivity is constrained by erratic rainfall, depleted soils, and limited access to irrigation. Prolonged droughts lead to food shortages and malnutrition, especially among children and the elderly. Women bear the brunt of collecting water and managing households during these periods, often walking long distances to fetch water and firewood.

In Sokoke, households living near the forest depend on forest products such as firewood, timber, and honey. Deforestation and wildlife incursions have reduced both resource access and safety, leaving communities vulnerable to income loss and environmental shocks. Youth unemployment is high, leading to unsustainable exploitation of natural resources such as charcoal production.

Mnarani, a coastal and semi-urban ward, faces unique vulnerabilities tied to its geography and economy. Fishing communities are affected by unpredictable weather and strong winds that restrict fishing days, reduce catches, and endanger lives. Informal settlements near the shoreline are at risk of flooding and saltwater intrusion, while poor waste management worsens environmental health risks.

Social vulnerability is also amplified by gender and social inequality. Women have limited control over productive assets such as land and credit, which restricts their ability to recover from disasters. In addition, a United Nations (UN) Study (Climate crisis driving surge in gender-based violence, UN study finds | UN News) findings demonstrate that extreme weather, displacement, food insecurity, and economic instability are key factors increasing the prevalence and severity of gender-based violence. These impacts hit hardest in fragile communities, where women already face entrenched inequalities and are more vulnerable to assault. According to the study every 1°C rise in global temperature is associated with a 4.7 per cent increase in intimate partner violence (IPV), the study cites. In a 2°C warming scenario, 40 million more women and girls are likely to experience IPV each year by 2090. In a 3.5°C scenario, that number more than doubles.

Youth face barriers in accessing employment and participation in governance, reducing their adaptive capacity. Persons Abled Differently (PADs) experience exclusion due to mobility and communication barriers, especially during evacuations. The elderly are often isolated and unable to respond quickly to emergencies.

Institutionally, inadequate coordination among departments, limited early warning dissemination, and resource constraints hinder timely disaster response. While local committees exist, many lack adequate training and logistical support to execute preparedness activities effectively.

Table 2: Vulnerability context in Kilifi County (Source: PCVA, 2025)

Vulnerable group	Source of vulnerability	Climate impact	Required support
Women	Limited access to land and finances; heavy care burden Surging GBV cases, underrepresentation in natural resource management & climate change adaptation planning	Food insecurity, increased workload during drought	Gender-responsive empowerment, access to credit and training

Youth	Unemployment, low participation in decision-making	Loss of income opportunities, migration	Skills development, inclusion in preparedness committees
PADs	Limited mobility and access to information and underrepresentation in decision making	Exclusion during evacuations and response	Accessible infrastructure and tailored communication as well mainstreaming in adaptation decision making
Elderly	Mobility constraints, dependency	Delayed evacuation, health vulnerability	Targeted social protection and community care
Farmers and fisherfolk	Weather variability, pest outbreaks, declining resources	Livelihood losses and income insecurity	Access to early warning, insurance, and diversification support

2.3 Impact evaluation

The cumulative impacts of these hazards on Kilifi County's social, economic, and environmental systems are substantial. Economic losses are primarily driven by reduced agricultural yields, damaged infrastructure, and disrupted market access. Recurrent droughts and floods have led to increased dependency on relief food and reduced productivity in both rural and peri-urban economies.

During drought seasons, water scarcity forces households to rely on distant or unsafe sources, increasing health risks and gender-based violence as women travel long distances in search of water. Crop failure results in food shortages and lower household incomes, while loss of pasture affects livestock health and market value. In Mwarakaya, some households have resorted to selling livestock at low prices to cope with drought impacts.

Flooding events, particularly in Mnarani, destroy homes and contaminate water supplies, leading to outbreaks of diarrhea and vector-borne diseases. Damage to roads and bridges isolates communities and disrupts access to schools and health facilities. Recovery is slow due to limited resources, and repeated shocks erode household savings.

Environmental degradation compounds the effects of these hazards. In Sokoke, deforestation has altered local rainfall patterns and degraded soil fertility, while in Mnarani, coastal erosion threatens tourism and fish landing sites. Degraded ecosystems provide less protection against climate extremes, increasing exposure to hazards.

These hazards also disrupt education and healthcare services. Schools are occasionally closed during floods or heatwaves, while health facilities experience increased caseloads during drought-induced malnutrition and flood-related disease outbreaks. The social burden falls heaviest on poor and marginalized households with limited coping capacity.

The increasing frequency of extreme events underscores the need for integrated and inclusive preparedness strategies that strengthen local resilience, protect critical infrastructure, and promote sustainable resource management across the County.

3 Objectives

3.1 Preparedness goals

The overarching goal of the Kilifi County Community Risk Preparedness Plan (2025–2030) is to strengthen the county's resilience to climate-induced and natural hazards by reducing exposure, minimizing vulnerability, and enhancing adaptive capacity across all social and economic sectors. The plan seeks to protect lives, safeguard critical infrastructure, and promote sustainable livelihoods, ensuring that communities can withstand, respond to, and recover from disasters more effectively.

Over the next five years, Kilifi County aims to establish a coordinated, inclusive, and proactive disaster risk management system that integrates early warning mechanisms, community preparedness, and rapid response structures at both county and ward levels. This approach aligns with Kenya's national climate adaptation agenda and Kilifi's County Integrated Development Plan (CIDP 2023–2027), ensuring consistency between policy goals and on-the-ground action. These efforts will be anchored on the principles of inclusivity, sustainability, and accountability, ensuring that interventions benefit all residents, particularly women, youth, and persons abled differently (PADs), who are often disproportionately affected by disasters.

The key preparedness goals are as follows:

1. Enhance institutional coordination and capacity for disaster risk management through stronger linkages between county departments, ward committees, and national agencies.
2. Protect lives and critical infrastructure such as roads, schools, health centers, and water systems from the impacts of floods, drought, and other hazards.
3. Strengthen community preparedness and early warning systems by ensuring timely, accessible, and inclusive information flow across all wards.
4. Safeguard vulnerable populations especially women, youth, and PADs through social protection measures, targeted training, and equitable access to resources.
5. Promote climate-resilient and diversified livelihoods through training on resilient design approach from homestead to watershed level including climate-smart agriculture, sustainable fisheries, eco-enterprises focusing on circular economies, and restoration of degraded ecosystems.
6. Mainstream gender equality and social inclusion in all preparedness, response, and recovery activities to ensure equitable participation and benefit sharing.
7. Foster environmental stewardship and natural resource restoration in areas such as Sokoke Forest and coastal ecosystems in Mnarani, thereby enhancing nature-based protection against hazards.
8. Build a culture of safety and continuous learning by institutionalizing drills, community awareness programs, and integration of disaster preparedness into education and health systems.

3.2 Success metrics

To measure progress toward the above goals, Kilifi County will adopt a set of success metrics and performance indicators that track institutional, community, and environmental resilience outcomes. These indicators are both quantitative and qualitative, allowing for continuous monitoring and adaptive management throughout the plan's implementation period. The metrics focus on reduction of disaster losses, improved community readiness, increased inclusion, and enhanced institutional coordination (Table 3).

Key Performance Areas and Indicators:

- Targeted GBV anticipatory actions for drought, floods and strong winds climate hazards

- Gender-responsive governance- inclusion of women, youth and PADs through capacity building across all villages
- Reduction in disaster losses: measurable decline in the number of households displaced, infrastructure damaged, and lives lost to floods, droughts, and other hazards.
- Improved response efficiency: reduced average time between hazard alerts and deployment of emergency response teams.
- Enhanced community awareness: greater percentage of households trained on resilience design from homestead to watershed level, early warning signs, first aid, and evacuation procedures.
- Resilient livelihoods: increased adoption of drought-tolerant crops, improved irrigation systems, and expanded alternative income sources such as beekeeping, tree nurseries, and ecotourism.
- Gender inclusion: higher representation of women and PADs in Ward Climate Change Planning Committees (WCCPCs), Community Forest Associations (CFAs), Beach Management Units (BMUs), Water Resource Users Associations (WRUAs) and Village Disaster Response Teams (VDRTs).
- Ecosystem restoration: measurable increase in reforested or rehabilitated areas, particularly around Arabuko-Sokoke Forest, riverbanks, and degraded coastal zones.
- Strengthened institutional capacity: establishment and operationalization of a County Disaster Risk Management Unit (CDRMU) and functional ward-level contingency plans.

Table 3: Sample preparedness Success Metrics for Kilifi County (Source: PCVA,2025)

Objective area	Baseline (2025)	Target (2030)	Key indicator
Community disaster awareness	35% of households aware	80%	Proportion of population trained on early warning, first aid, and response
Functional early warning systems	Operational in 2 sub-counties	Operational in all 7 sub-counties	Proportion of wards with active community early warning systems
Women in leadership in disaster preparedness	28% representation	55%	Representation of women in WCCPCs and County DRM Committees
Resilient livelihoods	30% of households engaged in diversified activities	70%	Percentage of households adopting climate-smart agriculture or alternative livelihoods
Ecosystem restoration	1,500 ha restored	5,000 ha restored	Area of rehabilitated forest, mangrove, and watershed ecosystems
Disaster response time	72 hours	24 hours	Average time between early warning alert and first emergency action
PADs inclusion in DRM activities	10% participation	40%	Representation of PADs involved in disaster preparedness programs
Institutional coordination	Partial inter-departmental coordination	Fully functional multi-sector coordination platform	Existence and operation of County DRM Coordination Platform

4 Preparedness Strategies

4.1 Prevention and mitigation

Prevention and mitigation form the foundation of Kilifi County's disaster preparedness framework. The objective is to minimize the likelihood and severity of climate-induced hazards through a combination of infrastructure improvement, natural resource management, and behavioral change. Given Kilifi's vulnerability to droughts, floods, and environmental degradation, the county will prioritize integrated water resource management, ecosystem restoration, and resilient infrastructure development.

In drought-prone areas such as Mwarakaya and Sokoke, the county will promote water harvesting and storage solutions, including the construction of rock catchments, solar-powered boreholes, and household rainwater harvesting systems. Communities will be trained on sustainable water use and maintenance of local water infrastructure through Ward Climate Change Planning Committees (WCCPCs) and Water Resource Users Associations (WRUAs).

In flood-prone coastal zones like Mnarani, drainage improvement and flood control will be prioritized. This will involve clearing blocked waterways, constructing stormwater channels, and reinforcing bridges and culverts to withstand heavy rainfall. The County Department of Public Works and Infrastructure will collaborate with the Kenya Rural Roads Authority (KeRRA) and local contractors to implement these measures.

Ecosystem-based mitigation will be central to Kilifi's strategy. Restoration of the Arabuko-Sokoke Forest, riparian buffers along River Rare and Sabaki, and mangrove forests along the coastline will enhance natural protection against floods, droughts, and strong winds. Communities will be mobilized for tree planting, forest patrols, and nature-based enterprises such as beekeeping and ecotourism.

The county will also enforce environmental management and land-use planning regulations to control deforestation, sand harvesting, and settlement in high-risk zones. Awareness campaigns through barazas, radio programs, and school climate clubs will promote responsible resource use and waste management.

A gender-sensitive mitigation approach will be integrated throughout implementation. Women's groups, youth organizations, and persons abled differently (PADs) will be engaged in activities such as tree nursery establishment, water resource committees, and community monitoring of environmental restoration projects. This will be done through consulting them on the labour inputs that would best serve them and the regenerative projects they are involved in including sharing unpaid care work with men.

4.2 Preparedness

Preparedness ensures that the county and its communities are equipped to respond swiftly and effectively when hazards occur. Kilifi County's preparedness framework emphasizes capacity building, early warning, contingency planning, and resource pre-positioning at both county and ward levels.

The County Disaster Management Unit (CDMU), in collaboration with the National Drought Management Authority (NDMA), Kenya Meteorological Department (KMD), and humanitarian organizations such as Kenya Red Cross Society (KRCS) and Plan International, will lead the development of multi-hazard contingency plans. These will outline roles, communication channels, and response procedures during emergencies.

Early Warning Systems (EWS):
The county will strengthen its EWS by combining scientific data (from KMD and NDMA) with local indigenous knowledge. Weather alerts will be disseminated through SMS, radio broadcasts, and community information boards. In coastal areas like Mnarani, fishermen will receive real-time marine weather updates through the Kenya Blue Economy and Fisheries platform to enhance maritime safety.

Training and Drills:
Ward Climate Change Planning Committees (WCCPCs) and Village Disaster Response Teams (VDRTs) in Sokoke, Mnarani, and Mwarakaya will undergo regular training on first aid, search and rescue, and emergency coordination. At least two simulation exercises and evacuation drills will be conducted annually to test readiness.

Health and Education Preparedness:
The County Department of Health will ensure that health centers are equipped with emergency supplies, disease surveillance tools, and cold-chain facilities for vaccines. More importantly, the health preparedness will encompass GBV response by providing first aid and treatment services and testing to aid in investigations and prosecutions. The health and education centres should also provide Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights awareness, sensitization and accessibility to information and supplies. Schools will integrate disaster awareness education into curricula and establish safety clubs to promote preparedness among students.

Resource Pre-positioning:
Each ward will maintain emergency storage sites stocked with essential supplies such as food, water, tents, dignity kits, first-aid and rape kits as well as SRHR supplies. Special provisions will be made for sanitary products and assistive devices for PADs.

Table 4: Key Preparedness Interventions (2025–2030)

Intervention	Responsible agency	Coverage area	Expected outcome
Community early warning systems	NDMA, KMD, County DRM Unit, KARLO	All sub-counties	Timely alerts reaching at least 90% of residents
Emergency drills and response training	CDMU, KRCS, Plan International	Sokoke, Mnarani, Mwarakaya	Enhanced readiness and faster community response
Ward contingency planning	County Planning Dept, WCCPCs	All wards	Operational ward-level response mechanisms
Health and sanitation preparedness	County Health Department	Flood- and drought-prone zones	Reduced disease outbreaks and improved medical response
Inclusive disaster education and awareness	County Education Dept, NGOs	Schools and youth groups	Increased participation of women and youth in preparedness
Disaster communication network	County ICT and Communication Office	County-wide	Effective coordination and reduced misinformation

4.3 Response

The response strategy ensures swift, coordinated, and equitable action immediately after a disaster strikes. It outlines procedures for communication, rescue operations, and humanitarian support to minimize loss of life and property. When a hazard occurs, the County Disaster Command Centre (CDCC) under the Office of the Governor will activate the County

Emergency Operations Protocol (CEOP). This will coordinate all relevant actors including NDMA, KRCS, KMD, Kenya Police Service, and county sectoral departments.

Evacuation and Relief:
Evacuations will prioritize vulnerable groups such as women, children, PADs, and the elderly. Each ward will have designated safe shelters (e.g., schools and churches) equipped with water, food, bedding, and first-aid supplies. Relief operations will follow an inclusive approach, ensuring that women and marginalized groups are represented in decision-making on distribution.

Communication and Coordination:
Real-time information will be shared through radio networks, mobile communication groups, and local administrators. A clear Incident Command System (ICS) will define leadership roles from the county level down to the village committees to prevent duplication and confusion.

Gender-Responsive Humanitarian Action:
A Gender and Protection Desk within the CDMU will address the needs of women and PADs, including access to dignity kits, psychosocial support, and protection from gender-based violence (GBV) in evacuation centers and continuity of SRHR services.

Post-Incident Review:
Each disaster event will be followed by an After-Action Review (AAR) to identify challenges, best practices, and recommendations for improvement. These findings will feed into the County Learning Hub for reference and capacity enhancement.

4.4 Recovery

The recovery phase focuses on restoring normalcy, rebuilding livelihoods, and enhancing long-term resilience. Recovery efforts will combine immediate humanitarian relief with sustainable reconstruction and livelihood diversification.

Short-Term Recovery:
Immediately after a disaster, the county will provide cash transfers, food aid, psychosocial support to affected households, especially those led by women or PADs. In addition, the county will put in place anticipatory actions to prevent and address GBV cases which have been shown to increase in tandem with disaster occurrences. Damaged water sources, schools, and health facilities will be repaired to restore essential services.

Long-Term Recovery:
Infrastructure reconstruction will follow a “build back better” principle to ensure improved durability against future hazards. Roads and bridges washed away by floods will be redesigned with adequate culverts and elevated embankments. Flood-prone schools and health facilities may be relocated to safer grounds where feasible.

Livelihood Restoration:
Households affected by disasters will be supported through climate-smart agriculture programs, provision of drought-tolerant seeds, restocking of livestock, and capacity-building in sustainable fisheries and forestry. Partnerships with organizations such as Plan International which is already supporting and building capacity of Village Savings and Loan Associations (VSLAs) in Kilifi County targeting women groups. This method is a life-changing approach, especially for the community members living in poverty with limited economic capacity, to engage in productive businesses and to secure an income. In Kenya, the transformation applying VSLAs among members has been significant in enhancing resilience especially for rural and indigenous women.

In addition, VSLAs are vehicles of inclusion, providing women and young women and men with opportunities to access capital to invest in their economic endeavors whether it be profiting businesses or self-employment. The method provides a much-needed solution to addressing barriers to access financial services such as lack of collateral, stringent terms and conditions from banks, physical access to financial institutions, prohibitive interest rates and minimum transaction amounts. Barriers that keep people living in poverty in the margin. Moreover, VSLAs provide accessible source of capital for women and other marginalized groups to more than to start up and run their own businesses, but also to provide for family needs as well as offering women an opportunity to exercise leadership and decision making within households, cooperatives, and communities. The VSLAs are self-managed and have encouraged women to step up and take leadership roles that often have led to other aspects than ensuring economic autonomy for the women, such as strengthened communities.

Ecosystem Rehabilitation:
Ecosystem recovery will include rehabilitation of degraded mangrove and forest zones, on farm forest production systems, and water catchment areas. These restoration projects will also serve as income-generating activities for women and youth groups through sell of tree and fruit seedlings, planting initiatives and ultimate harvests of on farm forest products for timber and wood fuel. In addition, restoration activities could include nature-based solutions and enterprises such as beekeeping delivering multiple benefits of conservation and livelihoods diversification to combat vulnerability and enhance climate change adaptation and preparedness. The restoration activities should be aligned with both Kenya's Forest and Landscape Restoration Plan (FOLAREP) 2023-2027 and the National Landscape and Ecosystem Restoration Strategy 2023-2032 (Towards Growing 1.5 Billion Trees Initiative).

Post-Disaster Needs Assessment (PDNA):
The CDMU, in collaboration with NDMA and the County Treasury, will implement a PDNA mechanism to assess damage, estimate recovery costs, and guide resource allocation. This will ensure transparency and efficiency in recovery planning.

Through these coordinated prevention, preparedness, response, and recovery strategies, Kilifi County aims to move from reactive disaster management to anticipatory resilience-building empowering communities in to adapt, thrive, and recover stronger from climate and disaster shocks.

5 Roles and Responsibilities

5.1 Climate risk management team

Effective implementation of the Kilifi County Community Risk Preparedness Plan (2025–2030) depends on clear institutional coordination, well-defined mandates, and strong collaboration among all stakeholders. The County Government of Kilifi will take the lead in coordinating disaster preparedness, response, and recovery through the County Disaster Management Unit (CDMU) housed within the Department of Environment, Climate Change, and Natural Resources.

The Office of the Governor will provide overall policy oversight and ensure that disaster risk management (DRM) remains a countywide development priority. The County Executive Committee Member (CECM) for Environment and Climate Change will chair the County Climate Change Steering Committee (CCCSC), which will serve as the main multi-sectoral platform for coordination among county departments, civil society organizations, and development partners.

Each county department will have a specific role in disaster preparedness planning and implementation:

- **Department of Water and Natural Resources:** Lead drought preparedness, water harvesting, and infrastructure maintenance.
- **Department of Agriculture, Livestock, and Fisheries:** Promote climate-smart agriculture, pest surveillance, and sustainable fisheries.
- **Department of Health:** Coordinate disease surveillance, medical response, and public health preparedness.
- **Department of Infrastructure and Public Works:** Strengthen roads, bridges, and drainage systems; integrate climate resilience into infrastructure design.
- **Department of Education and Social Services:** Promote disaster risk education and social protection for vulnerable groups.
- **Department of Finance and Economic Planning:** Allocate and monitor funding for preparedness and emergency response programs.

At the ward level, the Ward Climate Change Planning Committees (WCCPCs) and Village Disaster Response Teams (VDRTs) will serve as the operational arms for local coordination, community mobilization, and early warning dissemination. These committees will report directly to the CDMU and liaise with sub-county administrators for rapid response activation.

Non-state actors including NGOs, civil society organizations (CSOs), community-based organizations (CBOs), and private sector players will complement government efforts through capacity building, technical support, and mobilization of resources. Humanitarian organizations such as the Kenya Red Cross Society (KRCS), WWF-Kenya, and Plan International will play key roles in training communities, conducting simulations, and facilitating recovery programs.

National government agencies such as the National Drought Management Authority (NDMA), Kenya Meteorological Department (KMD), and National Environment Management Authority (NEMA) will provide technical guidance, climate data, and policy alignment with national disaster management frameworks.

Table 5: Institutional Roles in Climate Risk Preparedness

Institution	Key Responsibilities	Coordination Mechanism
Office of the Governor	Policy oversight, declaration of emergencies, resource mobilization	County Steering Committee
County departments of Environment & Climate Change, Gender, SRHR and PADs	Overall coordination of DRM and climate preparedness	County Disaster Management Unit (CDMU)
NDMA	Drought early warning, vulnerability assessment, emergency coordination	County EWS Network
KMD	Weather forecasting, climate data sharing, seasonal advisories	County Information Hu
County Department of Agriculture, Livestock & Fisheries	Climate-smart agriculture, pest control, food security	Agricultural Sector Working Group
County Department of Water & Natural Resources	Drought mitigation, water infrastructure maintenance	Water Sector Coordination Forum
County Depart of Health	Emergency medical response, disease surveillance	Health Disaster Desk
County Department of Infrastructure & Public Works	Roads, drainage, and flood control	Infrastructure Coordination Team
WCCPCs and VDRTs	Local coordination, early warning dissemination, first-line response	Ward-level DRM Teams
NGOs/CSOs	Community mobilization, gender mainstreaming, training	Partnership MoUs
Private Sector	Resource mobilization, CSR investments in resilience	Public–Private Partnership Desk
County Treasury	Budget allocation, financial oversight	County Fiscal Strategy Forums
County Assembly	Legislative support, oversight, and policy approval	Committee on Environment & DRM

5.2 Stakeholder engagement

Stakeholder participation is central to successful disaster preparedness and response. The County Government of Kilifi recognizes that managing climate risks requires inclusive, transparent, and multi-sectoral engagement involving all actors from county to village level.

A Multi-Stakeholder Coordination Platform (MSCP) will be established under the County Climate Change Steering Committee to facilitate coordination, information sharing, and joint planning. This platform will include representatives from:

- County departments and sub-county administrations
- NGOs and CSOs operating in climate and disaster risk sectors
- Private sector representatives (e.g., agribusiness, tourism, and energy sectors)
- Research and academic institutions such as Pwani University
- Faith-based organizations and traditional leaders
- Community groups including women, youth, and persons abled differently (PADs)

Regular stakeholder forums and public consultations will be organized to promote collaboration, review progress, and gather community feedback. The county will also strengthen linkages with regional and national networks such as the Coastal Counties Climate Change Network (CCCCN), the Kenya Red Cross Coastal Branch, and the NDMA Coordination Office for data sharing and technical backstopping.

Gender-responsive engagement will be prioritized to ensure that women's perspectives influence decisions on resource allocation, response priorities, and recovery planning. Youth will be empowered to lead in early warning dissemination, digital risk mapping, and community awareness campaigns, while PADs will be supported with accessible communication tools and infrastructure to ensure full participation.

Development partners will be encouraged to align their interventions with county priorities through formal Partnership Framework Agreements, ensuring coherence, transparency, and accountability in project implementation.

Through this inclusive and participatory approach, Kilifi County aims to build a collaborative disaster management ecosystem where every institution and community member contributes to resilience building.

6 Resource Allocation

6.1 Budget framework

Successful implementation of the Kilifi County Community Risk Preparedness Plan depends on the availability of adequate, predictable, and well-coordinated financial resources. The County Government of Kilifi will allocate dedicated budget lines for disaster preparedness, climate adaptation, and emergency response under the County Integrated Development Plan (CIDP 2023–2027) and the Medium-Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF).

Funding for the plan will be mobilized from multiple sources, including county government allocations, national transfers, development partners, private sector contributions, and community participation. The objective is to ensure sustained financing for prevention, preparedness, response, and recovery initiatives while promoting transparency, accountability, and equity in resource utilization.

Key funding sources include:

- County Government Budget Allocations – Annual appropriations across relevant departments such as Environment, Water, Agriculture, Health, and Infrastructure for climate risk management.
- National Government Transfers – Grants and support through agencies such as the National Treasury, NDMA, State Department for ASALs, and the Climate Change Directorate.
- Development Partners – Support from organizations like UNDP, FAO, WWF-Kenya, Plan International, and the World Bank, focusing on resilience, ecosystem restoration, and community training.
- Private Sector and CSR Contributions – Partnerships with local industries (e.g., tourism, agribusiness, and extractives) to fund water, environmental restoration, and safety initiatives.
- Community Contributions – Labour, materials, and local knowledge provided by CBOs, youth groups, and women's associations in implementing ward-level projects.

Table 6: Proposed indicative budget allocation for key components of the plan

Component	Key activities	Estimated budget (KES Million)	Potential funding source
Prevention & Mitigation	Flood control, water harvesting, reforestation, mangrove restoration	550	County Government, Development Partners, NGOs, Private Sector
Preparedness	Early warning systems, training, simulations, contingency planning	420	NDMA, NGOs, County Departments, Private Sec
Response	Evacuation centers, emergency stockpiles, rapid response units including support for SRHR	380	County Emergency Fund, Development Partners, Humanitarian Agencies
Recovery	Infrastructure rehabilitation, livelihood restoration, PDNA activities	500	County Treasury, World Bank, CSR Contributions
Coordination and monitoring	Capacity building, M&E, stakeholder coordination	240	County Government, Donor Support, PPPs

6.2 Resource mapping and logistics

Effective disaster preparedness relies on timely access to human, financial, and material resources. The County Disaster Management Unit (CDMU) will develop and maintain an Integrated Resource Inventory (IRI) for the county, detailing all available assets, personnel, and facilities relevant to disaster response and recovery.

The inventory will include:

- Emergency shelters such as schools, churches, and community halls designated as safe evacuation centers.
- Medical facilities, mobile clinics, and first-aid stations with essential emergency supplies.
- Firefighting equipment, tractors, water bowsers, and boats for coastal rescue operations.
- Communication and transport assets, including VHF radios, public address systems, 4x4 vehicles, and motorcycles.
- Stockpiles of essential items including food, tents, NFIs, and water purification tablets.

Each sub-county will designate a Resource Focal Officer to maintain updated records and coordinate logistics with the CDMU. The data will be digitized to ensure real-time accessibility during emergencies.

The county will also partner with local cooperatives and private enterprises for storage and distribution of relief supplies, ensuring that gender-specific needs such as sanitary items and assistive devices for PADs are prioritized.

In addition, Kilifi County will explore partnerships with nearby counties especially Kwale, Tana River, and Lamu for regional resource sharing in disaster response, such as joint rescue operations, cross-border early warning systems, and training programs.

6.3 Sustainability and financing mechanism

To ensure the long-term sustainability of disaster preparedness and climate resilience initiatives, the County Government of Kilifi will operationalize the County Climate Change Fund (CCCF) in line with the Public Finance Management (Climate Change Fund) Regulations, 2023. This fund will serve as a dedicated financing mechanism that enables wards, through their Ward Climate Change Planning Committees (WCCPCs), to access resources for localized adaptation and preparedness interventions. By devolving funds to the ward level, the county aims to empower communities to identify, design, and implement context-specific projects that directly enhance their resilience to hazards.

Each ward will receive an allocation equivalent to not less than one percent (1%) of the annual county budget, specifically earmarked for climate and disaster risk management activities. These allocations will support initiatives such as the construction of water pans and small dams in drought-prone zones like Mwarakaya, mangrove restoration and shoreline stabilization in Mnarani, and forest rehabilitation around the Arabuko-Sokoke Forest ecosystem. In addition, part of the funding will be directed towards strengthening local preparedness structures by training and equipping Village Disaster Response Teams (VDRTs) and Ward Climate Change Committees.

Kilifi County will complement the CCCF with a suite of innovative financing mechanisms designed to diversify funding sources and reduce dependence on annual budgetary allocations. The county will promote climate insurance schemes to protect smallholder farmers and fisherfolk from weather-related losses, establish public–private partnerships (PPPs) to invest in resilient infrastructure and early warning systems, and explore the issuance of green and resilience bonds to mobilize funds for large-scale ecosystem restoration and renewable energy

projects. In addition, corporate entities operating in the county will be encouraged to contribute through the County Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) Framework, channeling investments into community-based climate action and environmental protection programs.

To ensure transparency, accountability, and coordination of financial flows, the county will establish a Resource Mobilization and Partnerships Unit (RMPU) within the Department of Environment and Climate Change. The RMPU will coordinate donor engagement, monitor resource utilization, and maintain an updated inventory of ongoing and planned climate resilience projects. The unit will also facilitate quarterly reporting to the County Assembly and the public, ensuring that all stakeholders have access to information on fund allocation and performance outcomes.

Community participation will remain at the heart of financing and sustainability efforts. The county will encourage co-financing models where residents contribute labour, materials, or local expertise toward the implementation of ward-level projects. This participatory approach not only enhances ownership and cost-effectiveness but also strengthens the social fabric of resilience, as communities become active partners rather than passive beneficiaries.

Through these interlinked financing mechanisms, county allocations, innovative instruments, and community contributions, Kilifi County seeks to maintain a stable and sustainable funding ecosystem capable of supporting continuous disaster preparedness, effective response, and long-term climate resilience.

7 Communication Plan

7.1 Internal communication

Internal communication within Kilifi County's disaster management framework ensures that all departments, agencies, and ward structures operate under a unified command system. The County Government of Kilifi will implement a coordinated information-sharing protocol linking the County Disaster Management Unit (CDMU), Sub-county Administrators, Ward Climate Change Planning Committees (WCCPCs), and Village Disaster Response Teams (VDRTs) across the focus wards.

The County Disaster Command Centre (CDCC), under the Department of Environment, Climate Change, and Disaster Risk Management, will serve as the central hub for coordination. The Centre will operate on a 24-hour basis during emergencies and use integrated information systems such as digital dashboards, SMS alert networks, and radio communication to link stakeholders.

Hazard alerts and meteorological updates from the Kenya Meteorological Department (KMD) and the National Drought Management Authority (NDMA) will be received and disseminated by the CDMU to all sub-counties through official channels, including emails, short message services (SMS), and WhatsApp coordination groups. Sub-county Administrators will cascade information to Ward Administrators, who will mobilize community-level structures for local dissemination.

To maintain efficiency, an Incident Command System (ICS) will define roles and reporting hierarchies for all officers involved in disaster preparedness and response. Only authorized communication officers or spokespersons will issue official updates to prevent misinformation.

Each ward will designate an Information and Early Warning Officer responsible for compiling situation reports (SITREPs), documenting hazard events, and relaying real-time data to the county command centre. Tools such as Geographic Information Systems (GIS) and mobile data platforms (e.g., KoboToolbox) will support mapping of affected zones and impact assessments.

Quarterly coordination meetings between the CDMU, sectoral departments, and humanitarian partners such as the Kenya Red Cross Society (KRCS), WWF-Kenya, and Plan International will be held to evaluate the effectiveness of communication systems and update protocols. A digital repository will be maintained for storage of early warning bulletins, response reports, and hazard data for reference and performance tracking.

7.2 External communication

External communication is critical for timely, accurate, and accessible information flow to the public, development partners, and the media. Kilifi County Government recognizes that open and inclusive communication builds public trust, enhances preparedness, and promotes early action among the community.

The County Information and Public Communication Office, working with the CDMU, will coordinate all public communication during both normal and emergency periods. Key channels of external communication will include community radio broadcasts, SMS alerts, public address systems, social media, and community barazas.

Local radio stations such as Pwani FM, Kashifa FM, and Msenangu FM will broadcast early warning messages, weather updates, and evacuation notices in both Kiswahili and local dialects such as Giriama and Chonyi. For communities with limited access to technology, chiefs, village

elders, and religious leaders will facilitate face-to-face briefings through barazas and faith-based networks.

To ensure inclusiveness, communication materials will be translated into Kiswahili and supplemented with visual aids and sign language interpretation to accommodate persons abled differently. Women's groups, youth organizations, and community-based associations (e.g., WRUAs, BMUs, and CFAs) will be empowered as communication champions to ensure localized dissemination of critical messages.

During emergencies, the CDMU will issue verified press releases and public updates through the County Director of Communications. Social media platforms (Facebook, X/Twitter, WhatsApp, and YouTube) will be used to share situational reports, emergency contact numbers, and real-time updates.

To enhance accountability, the County Government will operationalize a Public Information and Feedback System (PIFS) that includes toll-free hotlines, online reporting portals, and suggestion boxes at ward offices. This will allow residents to report hazards, request assistance, and provide feedback on disaster response activities.

Partnerships will be established with media outlets, NGOs, and private sector actors to run seasonal awareness campaigns on flood preparedness, drought mitigation, and disease prevention. Continuous training for media personnel on responsible climate reporting will ensure that information shared is factual and does not incite panic.

Table 7: Communication Channels for Disaster Preparedness and Response

Communication channel	Target audience	Responsible entity	Frequency	Language/Accessibility
Community Radio (Pwani FM, Kashifa FM, Msenangu FM)	General public	County Information Office, KMD, NDMA	Weekly; daily during hazards	Kiswahili, Giriama, Chonyi
SMS Alert System	Households, traders, fishers, farmers	NDMA, CDMU, Safaricom Foundation	Real-time	Universal text-based
Barazas and Public Meetings	Local communities	Chiefs, Ward Admins	Monthly or as needed	Verbal/visual
Social media (Facebook, X, WhatsApp)	Youth, urban populations	County ICT Office, CDMU	Continuous	English & Kiswahili
Religious and Faith Networks	Rural households	Faith leaders, CBOs	Weekly	Kiswahili/local
Print Media & Posters	Schools, health facilities	County Education & Health Depts	Seasonal	Visual & pictorial
Toll-Free Hotlines and Online Portals	Affected households	CDMU	24/7	Voice, text, and online
Sign Language & visual aids	PADs	County Gender & Social Services	Continuous	Inclusive formats

8 Monitoring and Review

8.1 Introduction

Continuous monitoring and review of the Kilifi County Community Risk Preparedness Plan (2025–2030) are vital to ensure that interventions remain effective, inclusive, and responsive to changing climate risks. The monitoring framework provides mechanisms for performance tracking, learning, and improvement across all preparedness, response, and recovery actions. It encourages adaptive management and accountability among all institutions and communities engaged in disaster risk reduction.

The system emphasizes participatory evaluation, integrating both scientific and community-based knowledge. It will enable the County Government, Ward Climate Change Planning Committees (WCCPCs), and partners to measure progress against key performance indicators and revise actions based on emerging data and lessons learned.

8.2 Drills and Simulations

Regular drills and simulations form the cornerstone of preparedness testing and capacity strengthening in Kilifi County. The County Disaster Management Unit (CDMU), in collaboration with the National Disaster Operations Centre (NDOC), Kenya Red Cross Society (KRCS), and humanitarian partners, will coordinate multi-hazard simulation exercises twice annually at county, sub-county, and ward levels.

These drills will simulate different hazard scenarios such as drought emergencies, floods, human-wildlife conflicts, disease outbreaks, and strong winds reflecting the climatic realities of Mwarakaya, Sokoke, and Mnarani Wards. Each exercise will test communication flow, emergency response speed, community evacuation, and inter-agency coordination.

After every simulation, After-Action Reviews (AARs) will be conducted to identify operational strengths, weaknesses, and opportunities for improvement. The findings will inform revisions of contingency plans, resource allocation, and capacity-building strategies.

Gender and social inclusion will be integrated throughout the simulation process. Women, youth, and persons abled differently (PADs) will actively participate in designing and executing the drills to ensure that evacuation routes, shelters, and communication tools are inclusive and accessible. Female first responders and volunteers will receive specialized training in gender-sensitive emergency management and psychosocial support, particularly for survivors of gender-based violence (GBV).

Schools in the three wards will also be involved through School Safety Drills, organized in partnership with the Department of Education and the County Directorate of Disaster Management. These exercises will focus on safe evacuation, first aid, and fire response, building a culture of preparedness among learners and teachers.

The CDMU will maintain a record of all drills and ensure periodic evaluation of their effectiveness through community feedback sessions and independent assessments by external partners such as Plan International and WWF-Kenya.

8.3 Plan updates and reviews

Regular updates and reviews are critical to ensure that the Community Risk Preparedness Plan remains relevant to the evolving climate, socio-economic, and policy contexts of Kilifi County. The plan will undergo annual reviews and a comprehensive mid-term evaluation in 2027.

The County Climate Change Steering Committee (CCCSC), chaired by the County Executive Committee Member (CECM) for Environment and Climate Change, will coordinate the review process. Each implementing department and ward-level committee will prepare quarterly progress reports highlighting achievements, challenges, and lessons learned. These reports will feed into a consolidated County Preparedness Progress Report, submitted to the Governor and County Assembly for oversight and budget alignment.

Reviews will be informed by data from the Kenya Meteorological Department (KMD), National Drought Management Authority (NDMA), and County Integrated Monitoring and Evaluation System (CIMES). This ensures that the plan reflects real-time climate data and aligns with national frameworks such as the National Adaptation Plan (NAP 2015–2030) and the Public Finance Management (Climate Change Fund) Regulations, 2023.

The review process will focus on the following key areas:

- Functionality of early warning systems - including timeliness, accuracy, and accessibility of climate alerts.
- Institutional coordination - efficiency in inter-departmental and community-level communication.
- Budget performance - assessment of fund utilization and efficiency in resource deployment.
- Gender and inclusion indicators - evaluation of participation levels of women, youth, and PADs in preparedness and response mechanisms.
- Impact and sustainability - analysis of long-term outcomes and lessons for scaling successful interventions.

The review findings will guide policy adjustments, resource mobilization, and integration of climate preparedness priorities into the County Integrated Development Plan (CIDP) and County Annual Development Plans (CADPs).

8.3.1 Performance evaluation framework

A comprehensive performance evaluation framework will guide monitoring of the County's progress toward achieving the goals of the preparedness plan. This framework integrates both quantitative and qualitative indicators aligned with Kilifi County's Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) system and the National Performance Contracting Framework (Table 8).

Each responsible institution will report against a Resilience Performance Matrix covering prevention, preparedness, response, and recovery actions. The evaluation will include process indicators (e.g., number of drills conducted, equipment procured) and outcome indicators (e.g., improved response time, reduced disaster losses).

Table 8: Monitoring and Evaluation Framework for the Preparedness Plan (2025–2030)

Focus area	Indicator	Responsible institution	Reporting frequency	Data source
Early Warning and Awareness	% of households receiving timely alerts	NDMA, KMD, CDMU	Quarterly	Early Warning Bulletins
Infrastructure resilience	Number of flood-resilient structures constructed	Dept. of Infrastructure, Public Works	Annual	Project Reports
Gender and inclusion	% of women, youth, and PADs in preparedness committees	Gender & Social Services Dept, CDMU	Semi-annual	Committee Registers

Focus area	Indicator	Responsible institution	Reporting frequency	Data source
Livelihood diversification	% of households adopting climate-smart livelihoods	Dept. of Agriculture, Fisheries & Forestry	Annual	Household Surveys
Disaster response time	Average hours from alert to first response	CDMU, KRCS	Quarterly	Incident Logs
Financial accountability	% of allocated funds utilized as per budget	County Treasury, Environment Dept	Annual	Budget Review Reports
Knowledge sharing	Number of capacity-building and learning sessions held	County Learning Hub (KLH), NDMA	Semi-annual	Training Reports

8.3.2 Learning and knowledge management

Kilifi County recognizes that continuous learning and innovation are essential for effective preparedness. To this end, the County will establish a Knowledge and Learning Hub (KLH) within the Department of Environment and Climate Change to document lessons, success stories, and best practices from community-level interventions.

The KLH will serve as a central repository for hazard data, climate projections, and monitoring results, ensuring evidence-based decision-making. It will collaborate with institutions such as Pwani University, Kenya Marine and Fisheries Research Institute (KMFRI), and WWF-Kenya to conduct applied research on resilience building and climate risk management.

Community exchange visits and peer learning forums will be promoted to encourage the sharing of innovative adaptation practices such as water harvesting, nature-based restoration, and livelihood diversification.

Learning events, resilience fairs, and policy dialogues will be organized annually to facilitate multi-stakeholder engagement, linking government departments, NGOs, private sector actors, and community-based organizations. Documentation from these forums will inform future updates of the preparedness plan.

By embedding continuous learning and reflection, Kilifi County will cultivate a proactive, adaptive, and knowledge-driven disaster preparedness system that evolves with emerging challenges and opportunities.

9 Appendices

9.1 Maps of Hazard Prone Areas

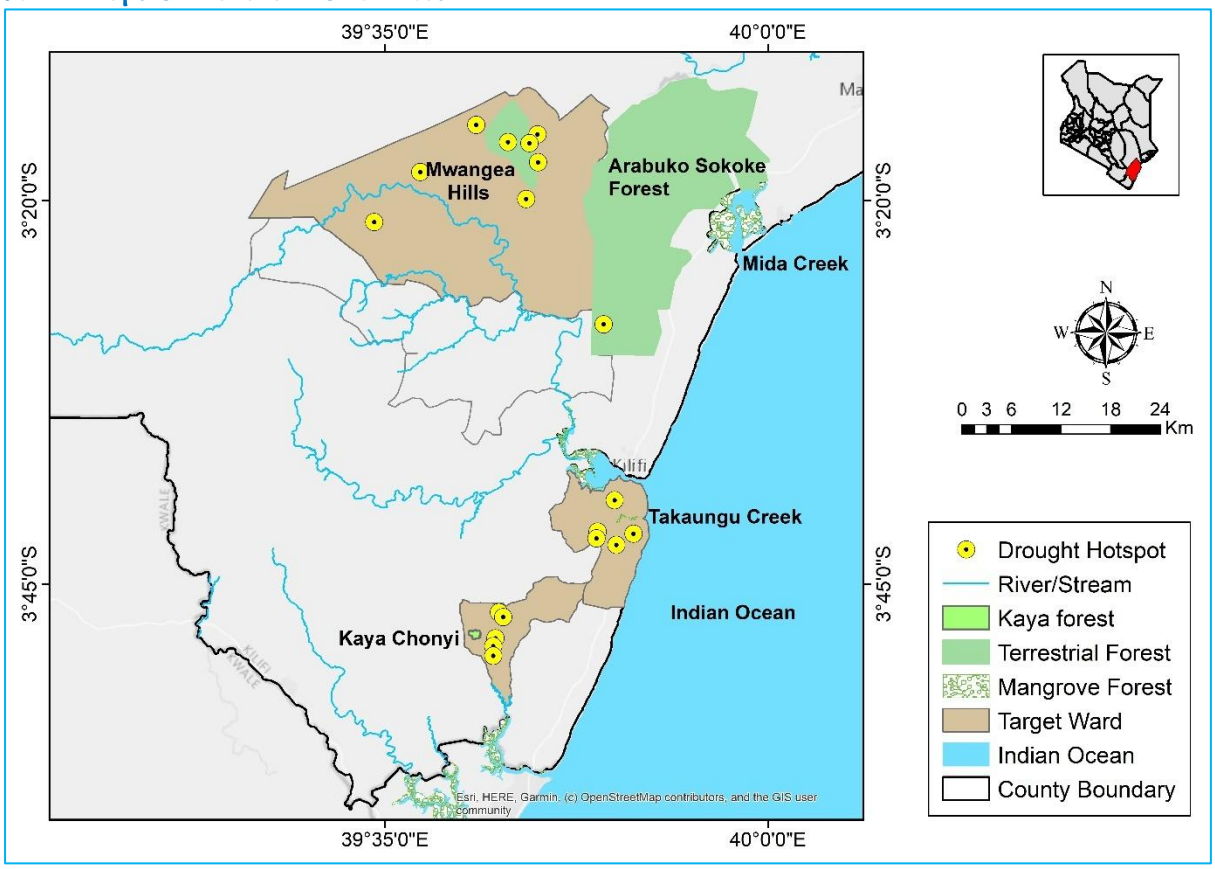

Figure 1: Drought hotspots in Kilifi County (Source: PCVA ,2025)

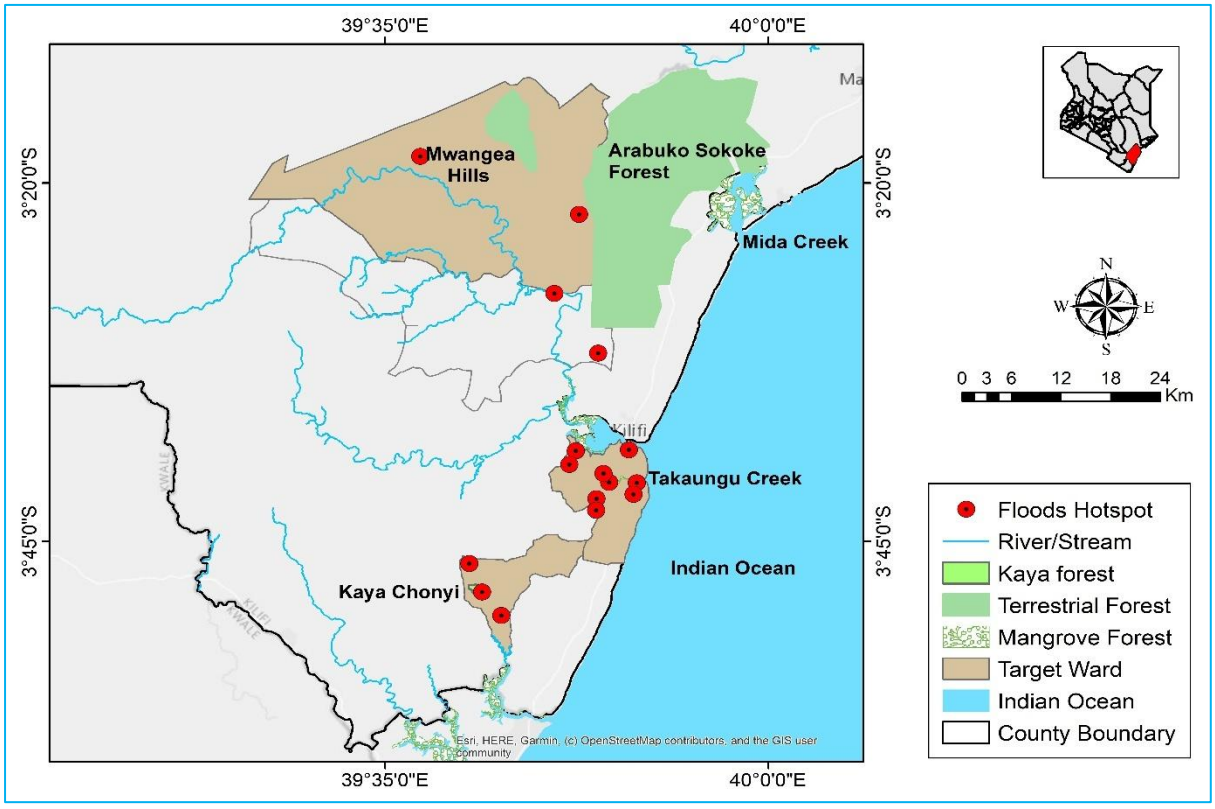

Figure 2 : Flood hotspots in Kilifi County (Source: PCVA, 2025)

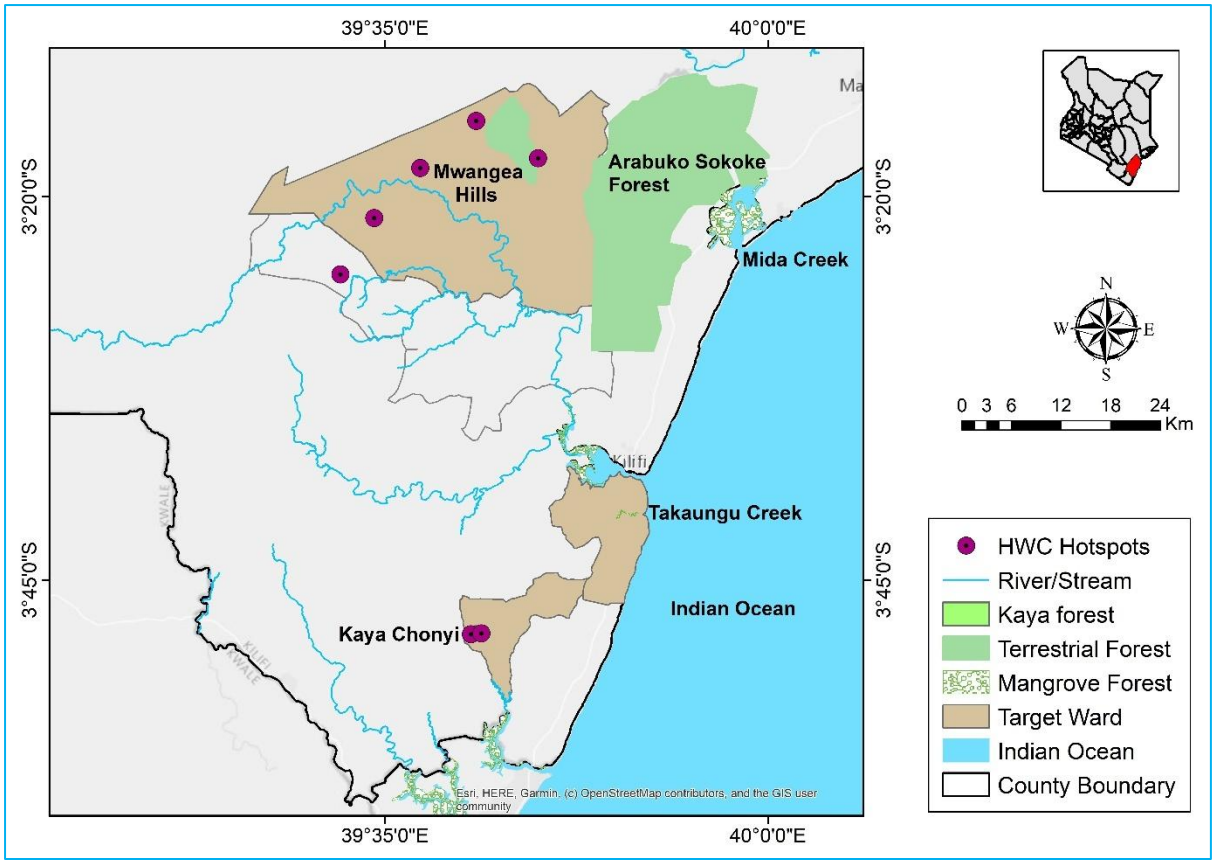

Figure 3: Human-Wildlife Conflicts hotspots in Kilifi County (Source: PCVA, 2025)

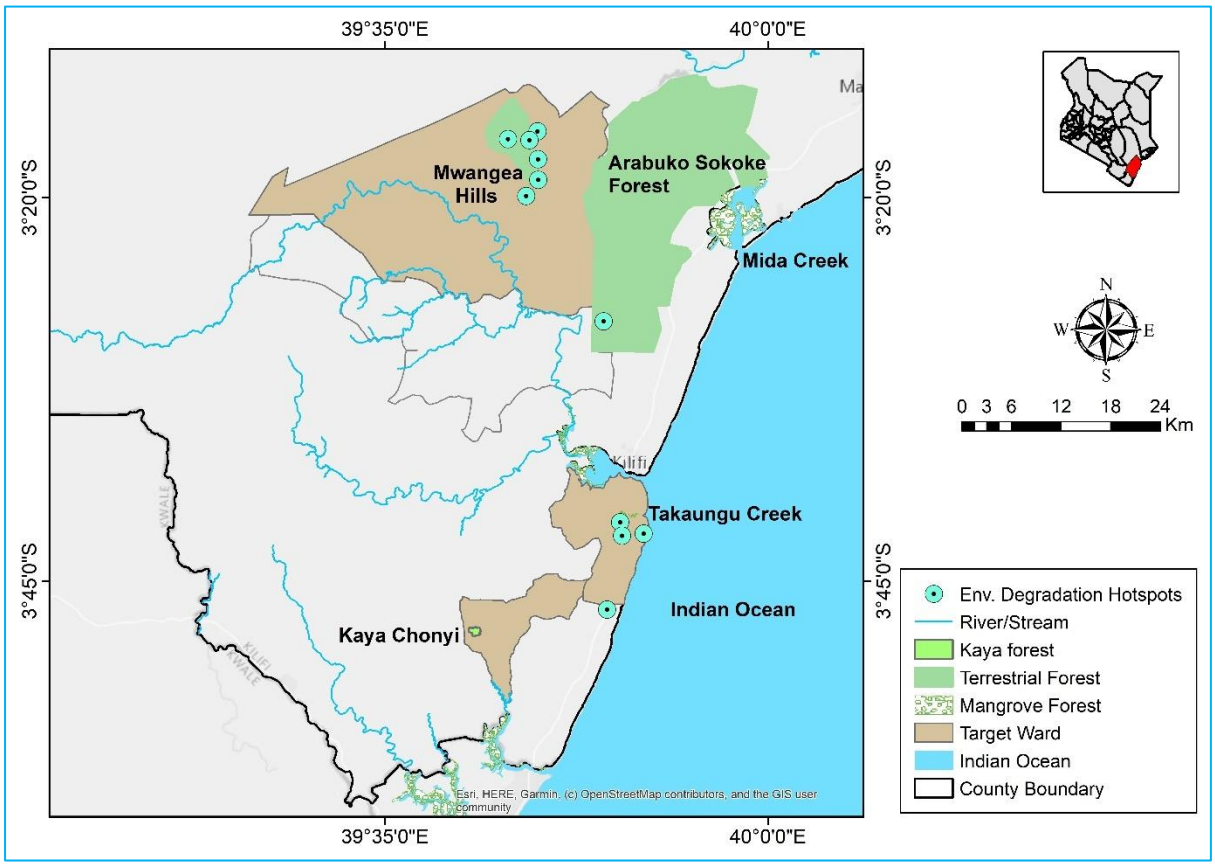

Figure 4: Environmental degradation hotspots in Kilifi County (Source: PCVA, 2025)

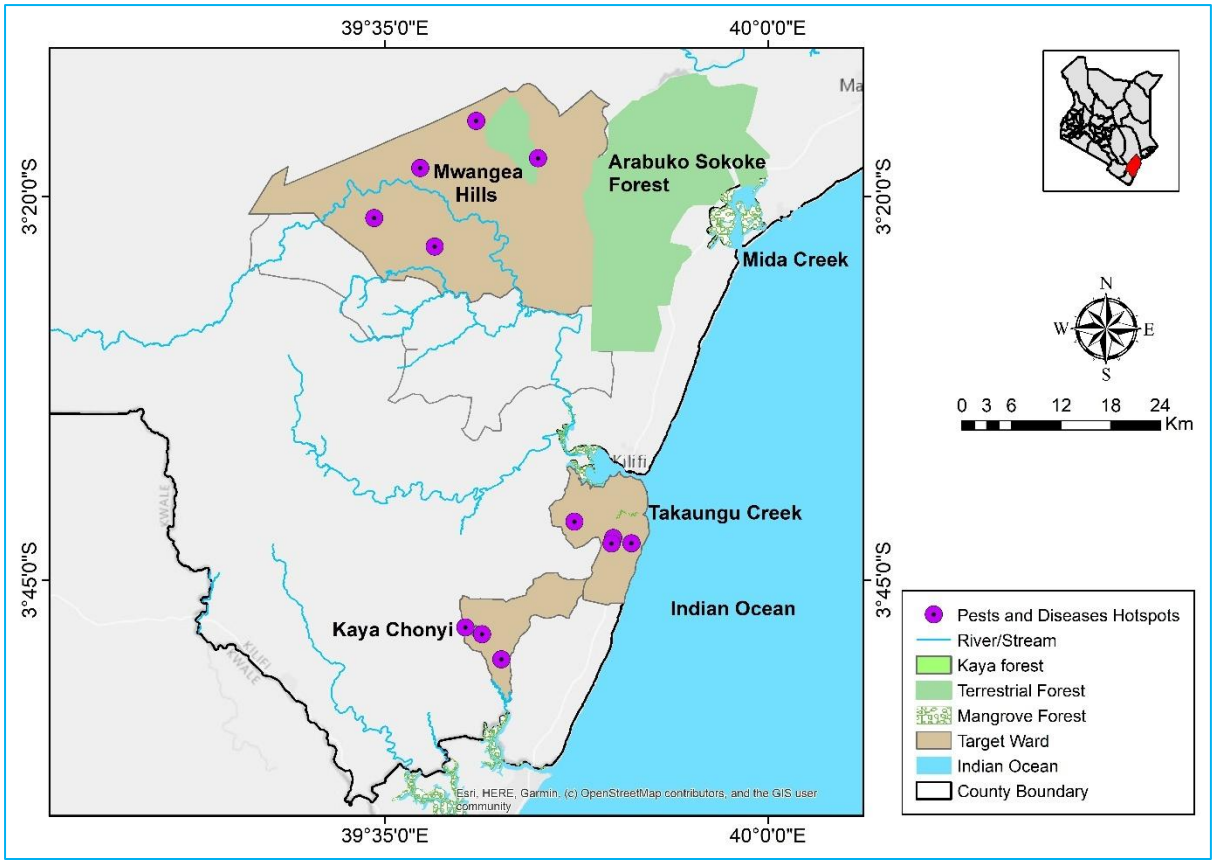

Figure 5: Pests and disease hotspots in Kilifi County (Source: PCVA, 2025)

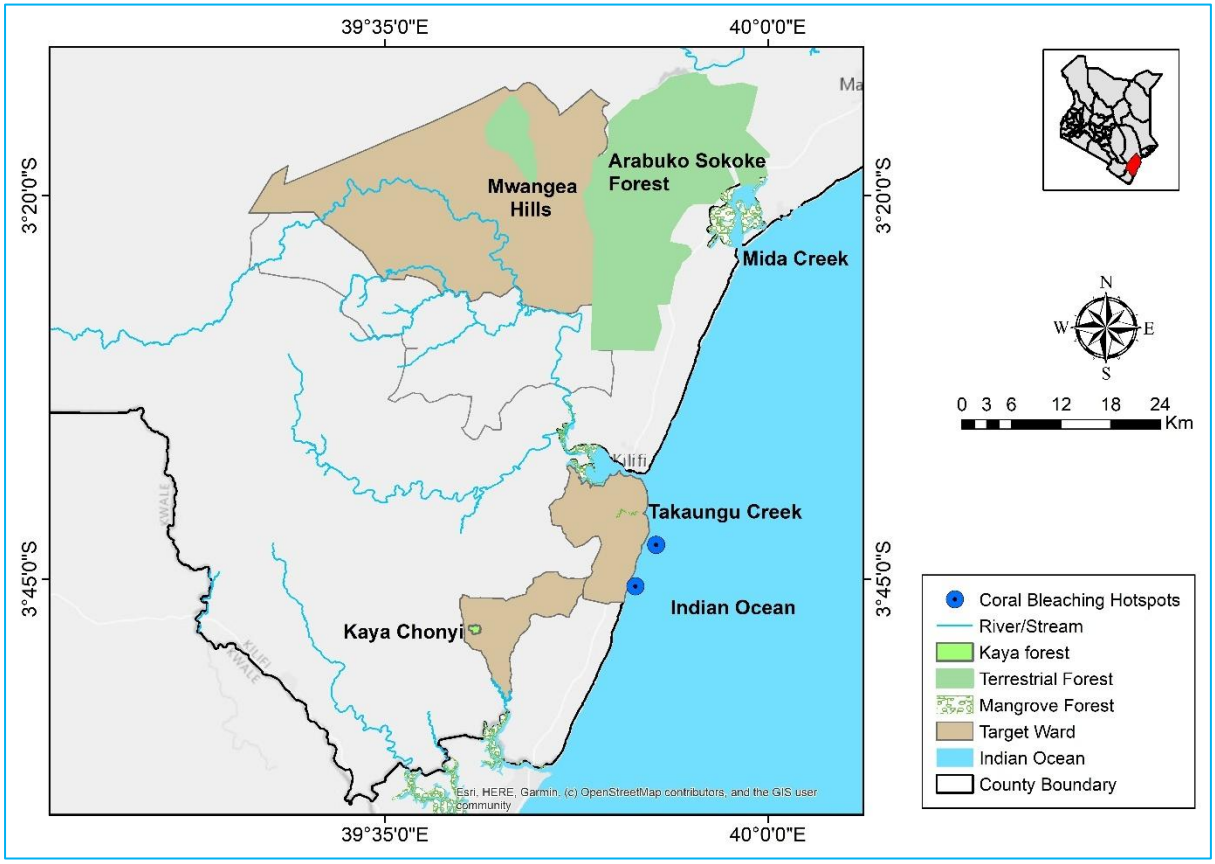

Figure 6: Coral bleaching hotspots in Kilifi County (Source: PCVA, 2025)

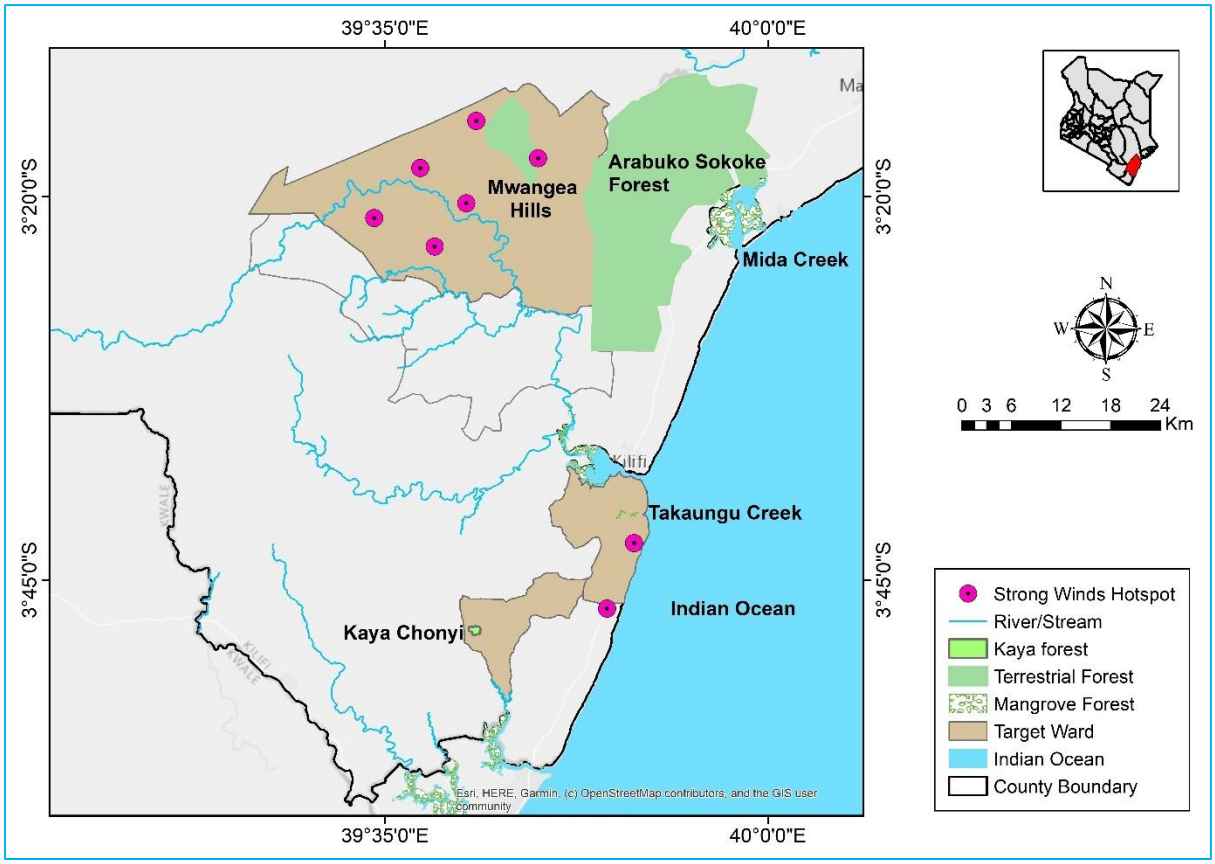

Figure 7: Strong Winds hotspots in Kilifi County (Source : PCVA, 2025)

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